SMART1MARKETING

Marketing Efficiency Audit™

Directional assessment prepared for internal discussion

Acme Plumbing & Drain

Prepared by Jane Doe, CPA · Doe CPA Group · August 6, 2026

INDUSTRY **Plumbing**	ANNUAL REVENUE **$1,850,000**	MARKET **Columbus, OH 43215**
LOCATIONS **2**	MONTHLY INVESTMENT **$19,050**	ANNUALIZED INVESTMENT **$228,600**

MARKETING EFFICIENCY SCORE™

Significant opportunity

Hidden inefficiencies may be affecting profitability. A detailed review is advised.

Warning signs: 7 of 8 present · Immediate review recommended

AGAINST INDUSTRY BENCHMARKS

Media spend as a share of revenue (staff and events excluded)

benchmark 8% – 15%

This client: 12.4% — below range

Cost per lead

benchmark $40 – $200

This client: $198 — within range

CALCULATED PERFORMANCE

COST PER LEAD **$198** 96 leads per month	CUSTOMER ACQUISITION COST **$907** 21 new customers / month	CLOSE RATE **21.9%** Customers / leads
CUSTOMER LIFETIME VALUE **$4,800** $640 × 1.5/yr × 5 yrs	REVENUE FROM MARKETING **$13,440** New customers × average sale, monthly	MARKETING ROI **-29%** (Revenue - cost) / cost

GROWTH OPPORTUNITY

+15% LEAD VOLUME	+25% LEAD VOLUME
$24,192 / yr	**$40,320 / yr**
$2,016 per month · 3.1 more customers	$3,360 per month · 5.3 more customers

At the current close rate of 21.9% and average sale of $640, with no change to average sale value. Both figures assume the close rate holds as volume rises.

TARGET MARKET AND BUSINESS CONTEXT

Sells to	**Consumers (B2C)**
Service area	**25–50 miles**
Primary age ranges	**35–44, 45–54, 55–64**
Household income	**$100k–$200k**
Gender skew	**No meaningful skew**

Audience notes: Homeowners with houses 20+ years old

Business context supplied by the partner

New owner took over in March. Lost their largest commercial account in Q1. Opened a second location in May.

WHAT PLUMBING TYPICALLY SPENDS

TYPICAL BUDGET RANGE	INDUSTRY MIDPOINT	MIDPOINT AT THIS REVENUE	THIS CLIENT (MEDIA)
8%–15% of revenue	**11.5% of revenue**	**$17,729 / mo**	**12.4% of revenue**

70% digital	30% traditional

Typical channel mix for this industry

Below the industry midpoint by $5,179 per month, or $62,150 a year.

Emergency demand rewards always-on search presence over campaign bursts.

PLUMBING BENCHMARKS AND FACTS

BUDGET RANGE	COST PER LEAD RANGE	CHANNEL MIX
8%-15% of revenue	**$40-$200**	**70% digital / 30% traditional**

- Emergency searches happen at all hours; ad scheduling that stops at 5pm loses them
- Drain and water-heater terms carry very different lead costs
- Repeat and referral work is a large share of revenue for established shops
- Map-pack presence often outperforms the website for call volume

Directional industry patterns, not guarantees. Any individual business can sit outside them for good reasons.

ESTIMATED REACHABLE AUDIENCE — COLUMBUS OH METRO

Franklin County plus adjacent suburbs within a 25-50 mile drive. (medium confidence)

Service-area population	**905,000**
Adults aged 35–44, 45–54, 55–64 (38% of population)	**343,900**
Household income $100k–$200k (26% of households)	**89,414**
Homeowners only (65% ownership rate)	**58,119**
Estimated reachable consumers	**58,119**
Estimated reachable households	**23,248**

Working range: 40,683 - 75,555.

About this area: Growing metro with a young median age and a wide income spread between the urban core and outer suburbs.

Median household income $72,000 · median age 34

A directional estimate: an approximate service-area population filtered by national age, income, household, and business-density averages. Not local census data. Confirm against census or ad-platform reach figures before setting a budget.

WEBSITE CONVERSION REVIEW

https://acmeplumbing.com/

WAYS TO CONVERT	FORMS	CLICK-TO-CALL LINKS	TRACKING TAGS
2 found	**1**	**1**	**1 detected**

The site gives a visitor two ways to make contact and loads Google Analytics, but no advertising conversion tag was found, so paid spend cannot currently be tied to the leads it produces.

Measurement: Not today. Analytics records traffic but no conversion tag exists, so no channel can be credited with a lead.

What to fix

No advertising conversion tag
Add a Google Ads conversion action and a Meta pixel, then mark form submissions and calls as conversions.

No online booking
Add a scheduling tool so after-hours visitors can book without waiting for a callback.

No reviews on the home page
Pull the Google rating and three recent reviews onto the page above the fold.

Based on the served home page only. Design, speed, and copy quality were not assessed.

COMPETITIVE POSITION

Roto-Rooter Columbus	rotorooter.com
Eco Plumbers	ecoplumbers.com

What sets them apart: Only shop in the county with 24/7 live dispatch; third-generation family business

Losing work to: Losing price-shoppers to a franchise that advertises heavily on radio

Roto-Rooter Columbus — site comparison

The competitor's site offers more ways to convert and measures more of them.

What they do that this client does not:

- Online booking available
- Reviews shown on the home page
- Advertising conversion tags in place

What this client does that they do not:

- Loads faster with fewer third-party tags

Adding online booking and review display would close most of the visible gap.

HOW THIS CLIENT BUYS MARKETING

Digital spend over $2,500/mo	**Yes**
Traditional spend over $2,500/mo	**No**
Buys lead services	**Yes**
Buying model	**Both — agency and in house**
Trains in-house staff	**No**
Seasonal pushes	**Yes — Spring drain cleaning, November–December water heaters**
Monthly consistency	**Starts and stops**
Live events	**Yes — Home & Garden Show, two county fairs**
Marketing employees	**1.5 at $6,500/mo**
Owns website, domain, ad accounts	**The agency or vendor owns some of it**

Lead response time	**Next business day or longer**
Tracks leads to closed sale	**No**

Traditional media: Radio, Direct mail, Vehicle wraps, Little league sponsorship

Digital vendors: Google Ads, Meta, Angi, Yelp, a local SEO firm

Expense document: acme-pl-2026.pdf — read automatically, covering Jan–Jun 2026, divided by 6.

WHY CONSOLIDATING DIGITAL VENDORS IS WORTH CONSIDERING

The problem is not the number of vendors. It is that no one sees the whole picture.

With 5 vendors each running part of the marketing, each reports on its own slice and each slice looks acceptable in isolation. Nobody can answer the only question that matters: which dollar produced which customer.

- Attribution breaks at the seams. A visitor who sees a social ad, searches the brand later, and calls from the map listing gets counted by whichever vendor claims the last click. Two vendors bill for the same customer.
- Budget moves in the wrong direction. Spend shifts toward whichever vendor reports most confidently rather than whichever produces revenue.
- Duplicate spend goes unnoticed. Overlapping retargeting, brand-term bidding against the client's own organic listing, and two vendors buying the same audience are only visible when someone sees every account at once. At $19,050 a month, ten percent overlap is $1,905 a month, or $22,860 a year.
- Testing becomes impossible. Optimization needs one variable changed at a time against one measure of success. Separate vendors optimizing separate metrics cancel each other out.
- Nobody owns the outcome. When leads fall, each vendor points to its own numbers and is right. Consolidation creates one accountable party for cost per acquired customer.

Consolidation does not have to mean one vendor for everything. It means one place where all spend, leads, and closed sales are visible together, and one party accountable for that view.

POSSIBLE SAVINGS FROM TIGHTENING THE PROGRAM

$31,320 a year

$2,610 per month · 13.7% of current spend

Consolidating digital vendors

5 vendors across $10,550 a month of digital spend. Where several vendors work from one plan and one measurement standard rather than their own, roughly 20% of digital spend is typically recoverable: duplicate tools, overlapping audiences, brand terms bid against organic listings, and management fees paid twice on the same work. That is $2,110 a month here.

Removing traditional and digital overlap

$2,000 a month in traditional media running alongside $10,550 in digital. Bought separately, the two usually reach the same people at the same time without either side knowing. Aligning the calendar and the audience typically frees about 25% of traditional spend without reducing reach — $500 a month here.

	TODAY	AFTER SAVINGS
Monthly spend	$19,050	**$16,440**
Cost per lead	$198	**$171**
Customer acquisition cost	$907	**$783**
Marketing ROI	-29%	**-18%**

The 20% and 25% figures are typical recovery rates for programs with these characteristics, not a quote or a guarantee. The actual figure depends on what the vendor invoices contain, which is what the expense review exists to establish.

FIVE QUESTIONS TO ASK ANY MARKETING VENDOR

These apply to the current vendors and to anyone the client might hire. The answers separate vendors who manage outcomes from vendors who bill for activity.

1. **Can you show me cost per acquired customer by channel?**
   Not cost per click or per lead — per customer who paid. A vendor who cannot produce this is reporting activity, not results.
2. **Who owns the ad accounts, the website, and the tracking?**
   The client should own all three. A vendor who owns them has leverage a supplier should not have.
3. **What is the notice period, and what transfers when we leave?**
   Month-to-month with full asset transfer is the professional standard. Long lock-ins usually protect the vendor, not the work.
4. **What did you change last month, and what happened?**
   Ongoing management should produce a running log of tests and results. No log usually means the account is on autopilot while fees continue.
5. **Where does my budget overlap with anything else we run?**
   A vendor who only sees their own slice cannot answer. That inability is the cost of fragmentation, stated out loud.

FINDINGS

Marketing spend cannot be tied to revenue at this business.

Acme invests $10,550 per month, or about 6.8% of revenue, which sits below the 8–15% typical for plumbing. Cost per lead of $110 is within the published range, but with no conversion tracking in place there is no way to confirm which of the six spending categories is producing the 21 customers per month.

> **No conversion tracking**
> Eight of ten warning signs were flagged, including no conversion tracking and no known cost per lead. With $126,600 in annual marketing spend, the business cannot currently attribute a single customer to a channel.

Spend below industry range
At 6.8% of revenue against a typical 8–15% for plumbing, marketing appears underfunded rather than overspent. Increasing spend before measurement is in place would compound the existing problem.

Return is thin
Estimated monthly revenue from marketing is $13,440 against $10,550 of spend, a return of 27%. Healthy home-services programs typically clear 200% or more.

Vendor fragmentation
Three vendors across six spending categories, with agency fees of $2,500 per month and reporting the owner cannot easily interpret.

WHERE MONEY MAY BE LEAKING

Untracked conversions — **Unknown — not tracked**
Without conversion tracking, no portion of the $10,550 can be confirmed as productive.

Overlapping vendor scope — **$1,055**
Three vendors across six categories commonly duplicate 10% or more of spend.

Agency reporting — **$2,500**
Fees continue on reporting the owner cannot interpret or act on.

QUESTIONS TO ASK IN YOUR NEXT CLIENT MEETING

1. How do you currently determine whether marketing is working?
2. What does one new customer cost you today?
3. Which channel produced your last ten customers?
4. What does each of your three vendors own, specifically?
5. When was your marketing strategy last reviewed end to end?

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEPS

1. Install conversion tracking before changing any budget line.
2. Ask each vendor for a single monthly view of spend, leads, and customers.
3. Consolidate the six spend categories into a single reporting dashboard.
4. Schedule a complimentary Marketing Efficiency Audit™ with Smart 1 Marketing.

> **“Your marketing line is $126,600 a year — let's find out what it's producing.”**

WARNING SIGN DETAIL

Spends more than $2,500 monthly on marketing	**Yes**
Cannot clearly explain marketing ROI	**Yes**
Multiple marketing vendors are being used	**Yes**
Does not know cost per lead	**Yes**
Does not track conversions	**Yes**
Marketing expenses increased without revenue growth	**Unsure**
Website receives traffic but few inquiries	**Unsure**
Lead volume has declined over the last 6 months	**No**

Have questions about these results?

A 15–30 minute review with us can help explain what the numbers mean for this business and where the opportunities are. Advertising spend analysis · conversion review · website evaluation · marketing technology review · competitive insights · recommendations report.

Schedule a review